

The Lake Isle of Innisfree

(William Butler Yeats)

Key Points

Title

Title has been inspired from an island in Lough Gill, a lake in Yeats's home country of Sligo, Ireland.

Setting

Irish countryside
Cabin lakeside
Roadway pavements

Tone and Mood

Peaceful
Thoughtful
Expectant
Harmonious

Elements of Poem

Moral Values

Return to Nature to enjoy peaceful, stress-free lives
Learn to appreciate the beauty of Nature

Themes

Nature and Renewal
Rural versus Urban
Memory and Nostalgia
The Beauty of Ireland

Persona

The poet -
Yeats himself



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The "The Lake Isle of Innisfree" describes the speaker's desire to leave the city and go to the countryside of western Ireland.

The speaker declares his intention to go to Innisfree.

He wants to build a cabin out of clay and sticks, grow beans and tend to a beehive so he can gather honey.

He wants to live alone in a clearing on the island.

The speaker says that this life in the Irish countryside will bring him peace.

He describes the fog that settles over the lake and island in the morning and the night on Innisfree as shining with stars and the daytime as purple with the color of heather reflected in the lake.

The speaker describes the sounds of creatures like crickets and linnets.

The speaker again announces that he will go to Innisfree.

He says that he always imagines the sound of the lake lapping against the island.

Though he is on busy roads and sidewalks, it is as if he can hear the sounds of the island in Ireland deep within his heart.

